

Solve practical problems applying Pythagoras' theorem and trigonometry of right-angled triangles, including problems involving direction and angles of elevation and depression

Learning intention

- solve practical problems applying Pythagoras' theorem and trigonometry of right-angled triangles, including problems involving direction and angles of elevation and depression.

Teach and model

- applying right-angled trigonometry to solve navigation problems involving bearings.
- investigating how autonomous vehicles use algorithms that use Pythagoras' theorem and trigonometry to calculate distance and navigate spaces.
- applying Pythagoras' theorem and trigonometry to problems in surveying and design, where three-dimensional problems are decomposed into two-dimensional problems.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.